

## HARVEST HYMN

**Let us do these activities before we read.**

I Work in pairs and share your responses with your classmates and teacher.

1. India celebrates many harvest festivals. When is the harvest festival
2. A hymn refers to a song of praise.
  - (i) To whom do we offer a hymn ?
  - (ii) When and where do we sing a hymn ?
  - (iii) Why do we offer it ?

II Work in pairs. Read the paragraph and select the correct meaning for each underlined word from the options given below. Share your answers with your classmates and teacher.

Under the golden 1. radiance of the evening sun, the villagers gathered to pay 2. tribute to their 3. cherished elder, who had dedicated his life to their well-being. His wise 4. counsel had guided generations, steering them through challenges. Known for his 5. munificent spirit, he never hesitated to share his resources generously.

- |               |   |               |                 |
|---------------|---|---------------|-----------------|
| 1. radiance   | : | (i) glow      | (ii) brilliance |
| 2. tribute    | : | (i) respect   | (ii) gratitude  |
| 3. cherished  | : | (i) preserved | (ii) loved      |
| 4. counsel    | : | (i) advice    | (ii) decision   |
| 5. munificent | : | (i) rich      | (ii) generous   |



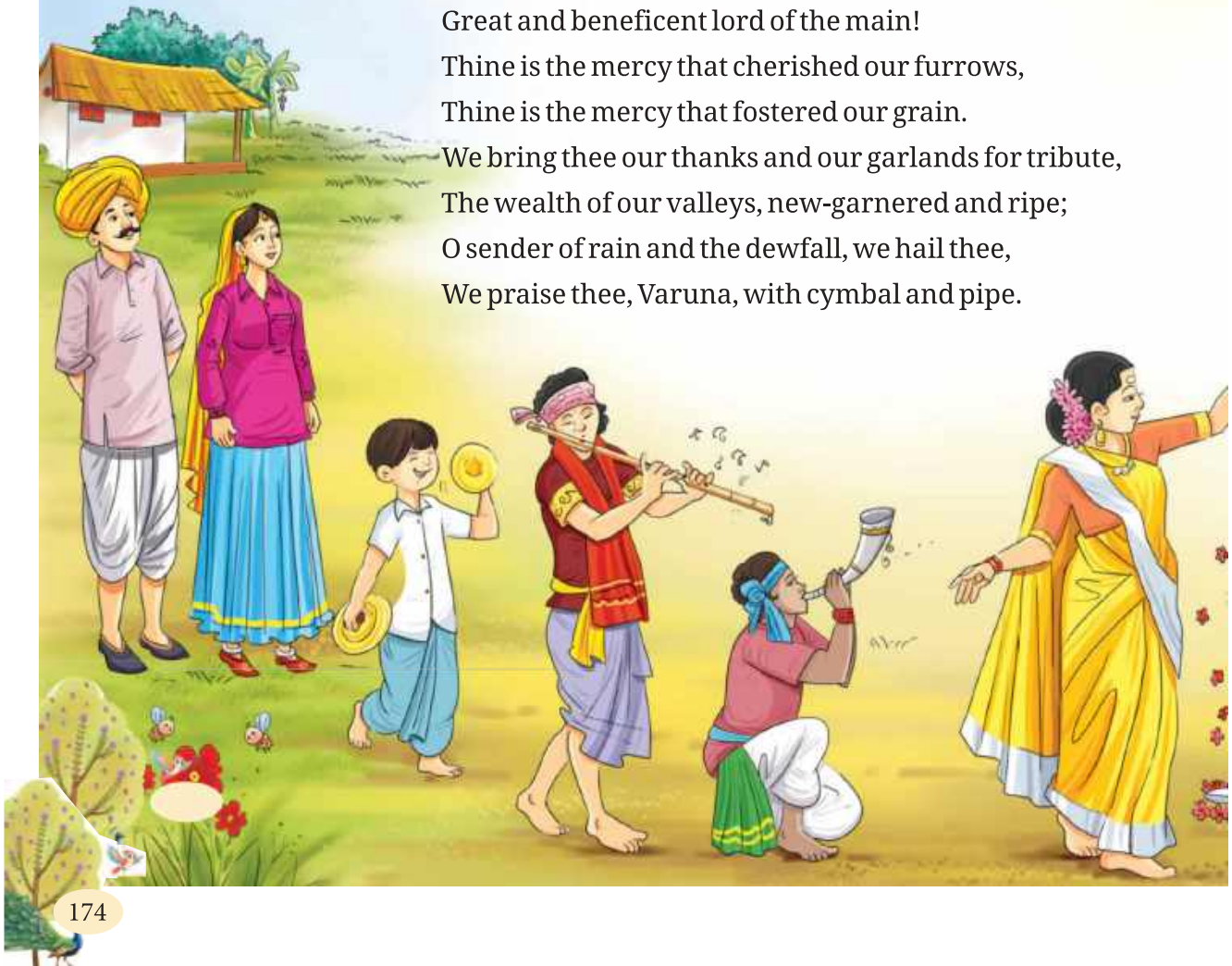


## Let us read

### Men's Voices:

Lord of the lotus, lord of the harvest,  
Bright and munificent lord of the morn!  
Thine is the bounty that prospered our sowing,  
Thine is the bounty that nurtured our corn.  
We bring thee our songs and our garlands for tribute,  
The gold of our fields and the gold of our fruit;  
O giver of mellowing radiance, we hail thee,  
We praise thee, O Surya, with cymbal and flute.

Lord of the rainbow, lord of the harvest,  
Great and beneficent lord of the main!  
Thine is the mercy that cherished our furrows,  
Thine is the mercy that fostered our grain.  
We bring thee our thanks and our garlands for tribute,  
The wealth of our valleys, new-garnered and ripe;  
O sender of rain and the dewfall, we hail thee,  
We praise thee, Varuna, with cymbal and pipe.



**Women's Voices:**

Queen of the gourd-flower, queen of the harvest,  
 Sweet and omnipotent mother, O Earth !  
 Thine is the plentiful bosom that feeds us,  
 Thine is the womb where our riches have birth.  
 We bring thee our love and our garlands for tribute,  
 With gifts of thy opulent giving we come;  
 O source of our manifold gladness, we hail thee,  
 We praise thee, O Prithvi, with cymbal and drum.

**All Voices:**

Lord of the Universe, Lord of our being,  
 Father eternal, ineffable Om !  
 Thou art the Seed and the Scythe of our harvests,  
 Thou art our Hands and our Heart and our Home.  
 We bring thee our lives and our labours for tribute,  
 Grant us thy succour, thy counsel, thy care.  
 O Life of all life and all blessing, we hail thee,  
 We praise thee, O Bramha, with cymbal and prayer.

Sarojini Naidu



## Let us discuss

- I Write the stanza number for the main idea of each stanza given below. Share your answers with your classmates and teacher.

|    |                                                                                                                   |  |
|----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| 1. | The speakers recognise the lord's kindness and praise him for nourishing the field.                               |  |
| 2. | The speakers praise the generosity of the creator of the universe who ensures a rich harvest.                     |  |
| 3. | The speakers devote their lives and work as a mark of respect to the lord and seek his support, wisdom, and care. |  |
| 4. | The speakers pay homage to the Earth and appreciate her role in supporting life, by dedicating their harvest.     |  |
| 5. | The speaker express their gratitude for the wealth of their village.                                              |  |

- II Fill in the blanks by choosing the appropriate words or phrases from within the brackets.

- The setting of the poem is a rural landscape, possibly during a \_\_\_\_\_ (harvest/religious) festival.
- The tone of the poem is respectful and celebratory because it praises \_\_\_\_\_ (the men and women/ nature and the Lord) with deep respect and gratitude.
- In the line '*Thou art our Hands and our Heart and our Home*', the letter 'h' is capitalised in 'Hands', 'Heart' and 'Home' because \_\_\_\_\_. (it represents the hard work of farmers/God resides in them)

- III Identify the poetic device used in the following lines from the poem.
- *Bright and munificent lord of the morn!*
  - *We bring thee our lives and our labours for tribute*
- IV Match the lines from the poem in **Column 1** with their expressions in **Column 2**. Choose the appropriate poetic device from the box given below and write in **Column 3**.

imagery alliteration simile metaphor personification

| Column 1                                                   | Column 2                                                                         | Column 3 |
|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| 1. <i>sweet and omnipotent mother</i>                      | (i) creates a clear description of the scene and appeals to the senses           |          |
| 2. <i>The wealth of our valleys, new-garnered and ripe</i> | (ii) implied comparison of growth and reaping with beginning and end of all life |          |
| 3. <i>Thou art the Seed and the Scythe</i>                 | (iii) the earth is being given human-like qualities                              |          |

- V Certain words or phrases are repeated in the same line of the poem. For example, *The gold of our fields and the gold of our fruit*;  
Find more such repetitions from the poem. What is the poet's purpose of using repetition in the poem?
- VI The poem uses **symbolism** to convey deeper meanings. Match the symbols in Column 1 with the meanings they convey in Column 2.

| Column 1                      | Column 2                                                                |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. <i>Prithvi</i> (the Earth) | (i) light, energy, life—representing the giver of warmth and prosperity |
| 2. <i>Surya</i> (the Sun)     | (ii) mercy and nourishment—crucial for agriculture and sustenance       |
| 3. <i>Varuna</i> (Rain)       | (iii) fertile land, motherhood, nurturing—the source of all life        |



## Let us think and reflect



I Read the given extracts and answer the questions that follow.

1. *We bring thee our songs and our garlands for tribute,  
The gold of our fields and the gold of our fruit;  
O giver of mellowing radiance, we hail thee,  
We praise thee, O Surya, with cymbal and flute.*
  - (i) What does the act of bringing songs and garlands as tribute suggest about the people's relationship with the divine?
    - A. They fear the gods and wish to calm them in any way possible.
    - B. They have a deep sense of reverence and gratitude towards the divine.
    - C. They are forced to perform rituals without understanding the divine.
    - D. They depend on the gods for their daily needs and activities.
  - (ii) Complete the following sentence suitably.  
The word 'gold' in the phrases '*the gold of our fields*' and '*the gold of our fruit*' symbolises \_\_\_\_\_.
  - (iii) How does the description '*O giver of mellowing radiance*' help us understand Surya's role in the harvest?
  - (iv) Fill in the blank by selecting the correct option from those given in the brackets.  
The use of cymbal and flute signifies \_\_\_\_\_. (joy and celebration/meditation and worship)

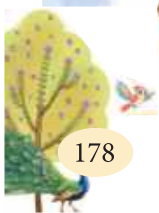
2. *All Voices:*

*Lord of the Universe, Lord of our being,  
Father eternal, ineffable Om!*

*Thou art the Seed and the Scythe of our harvests,*

*Thou art our Hands and our Heart and our Home.*

- (i) In the phrase '*Lord of our being*,' what does the word 'being' most likely refer to?
  - A. Our physical body
  - B. Our entire existence
  - C. Our spiritual practices
  - D. Our earthly possessions



- (ii) Identify whether the following statement is true or false.  
The imagery of 'the Seed and the Scythe' symbolises the divine's role as both the beginning (creation) and the end (harvest) of the agricultural cycle.
- (iii) Identify the phrases from the extract that mean the following:  
A. The divine as a timeless, everlasting presence  
B. Beyond human comprehension or description
- (iv) How do we know that these lines from the extract are spoken as a chorus?

II Some poets and authors use words that are no longer a part of common usage. Such words are called archaic words.

Work in pairs. Read the sentences given below. Match the underlined archaic words in Column 1 with their meanings in Column 2. Share your answers with your classmates and teacher.

'Thou art my friend, and I trust thee. Thy kindness is great, and everything that is mine is thine.'

| Column 1 | Column 2            |
|----------|---------------------|
| 1. thou  | (i) yours           |
| 2. art   | (ii) you (object)   |
| 3. thee  | (iii) you (subject) |
| 4. thy   | (iv) are            |
| 5. thine | (v) your            |

III. Answer the following questions.

- Why do the farmers hail the God of rain?
- What is being referred to as 'wealth of our valleys'? Why?
- State one reason why the women refer to the Earth as a 'source of manifold gladness'.
- Why does everyone in the poem offer their 'labours for tribute'?
- Why has the poet presented the poem as voices of men, women, and all voices?
- How does the poet create the joyous atmosphere of rural India at harvesting time?
- Why is the poem presented as a hymn?



### Let us learn

I Match the pictures of the farming implements given in Column 1 with their use given in Column 2. Then, fill in the blanks in Column 3 to complete the name of the implement.



| Column 1                                                                               | Column 2                                                                                                            | Column 3    |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| 1.    | (i) A tool with a long handle with metal teeth for collecting hay or leaves.                                        | S _ C K L _ |
| 2.    | (ii) A small hand tool used for digging and making shallow furrows.                                                 | S C _ T H _ |
| 3.    | (iii) A hand-held tool with a curved blade attached to a short handle. It is used for harvesting crops.             | P L _ _ G H |
| 4.    | (iv) A tool pulled by oxen. It is used for turning over the soil in the field so that seeds can be sown or planted. | T R _ W _ L |
| 5.   | (v) A farm tool having a flat rectangular blade attached to a long wooden handle used for digging the soil.         | R _ K _     |
| 6.  | (vi) A hand-held tool with a long-curved blade attached to a long handle used for cutting tall grass.               | S P _ D _   |

- II Choose the correct synonyms for the underlined words in the given sentences from the box below. Circle the words or phrases in the sentences that helped you to infer the meanings. One example has been done for you.

generous help brightness indescribable kind

- The king was beneficent to the poor because he took good care of them.  
**synonym:** kind
- He was *munificent* towards the needy and donated a lot for their health care.  
**synonym:** \_\_\_\_\_

3. When he lost his job, all his friends gave him succour by supporting him with money.

**synonym:** \_\_\_\_\_

4. When the sun's rays came into the dark room, the whole room was full of radiance.

**synonym:** \_\_\_\_\_

5. The little girl was speechless with ineffable joy when she got her birthday gift from her aunt.

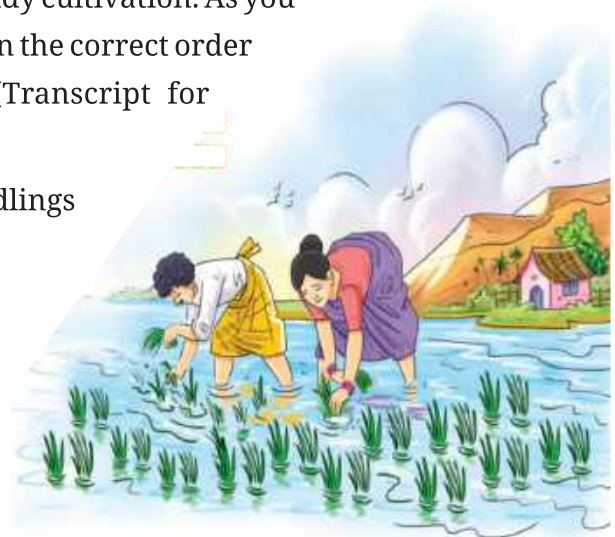
**synonym:** \_\_\_\_\_



### Let us listen

- I Listen to the talk about paddy cultivation. As you listen, number the events in the correct order in which they happen. (Transcript for teacher on page 203)

1. Transplanting of seedlings
2. Ploughing of soil
3. Threshing of grains
4. Puddling of land
5. Harvesting of paddy
6. Irrigating the field
7. Milling of rice



- II Now, listen to the talk again. As you listen, choose the correct option to answer the questions that follow.

1. What is the main step in preparing the soil for cultivation of rice?  
(i) Ploughing the soil (ii) Clearing the soil (iii) Puddling the soil
2. How long does it take for rice seeds to grow into seedlings before being transplanted?  
(i) 2–3 weeks (ii) 4–5 weeks (iii) 6–7 weeks



3. Why is drying rice grains important after threshing?

- (i) To get rice seeds for plantation
- (ii) To separate the rice grains easily
- (iii) To store the rice grains for longer



### Let us speak

I In English, some letters are not pronounced in certain words. For example, in words like 'knife', 'knowledge', and 'know', the first letter 'k' is not pronounced. Let us look at a few more such examples.

- In the words given below the letter 'n' is silent when it appears with 'm' at the end of the word.

hymn, column, autumn, solemn

Now, say these words aloud.

- In the words given below the letter 'b' is silent when it appears with 'm'.

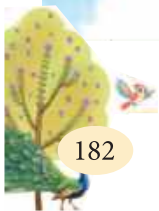
womb, tomb, bomb, climb, comb

Now, say these words aloud.

II In our country, harvest is celebrated with the preparation of delicious dishes. Work in groups and make a presentation on any popular dish made during the harvest festival in your region. Use the prompts given in the box to make your presentation. Make sure that all the members share their views.

Include the following:

- What is the dish called? Is it known by any other name in other parts of India ?
- What ingredients are used to make the dish ?
- How is the dish prepared ?
- How is the dish served ?
- What does the dish taste like ?
- What is the special ritual related to the preparation of this dish ?
- Describe any special memory associated with the preparation of this dish.



| Column 1                                           | Column 2                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Greet the audience                                 | Good morning to all of you gathered here...                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Introduce the members of your group and your topic | Today we, ____, ____ and ____ are here to tell you about...                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Explain the structure of your presentation         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• We will start off with...</li> <li>• Following this, we will move on to...</li> <li>• The next point we will deal with is...</li> <li>• Finally, we will speak about...</li> </ul> |
| Speak about the first point                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Let's begin by...</li> <li>• I'd like to start by...</li> </ul>                                                                                                                    |
| Describe the details                               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Now I'll move on to...</li> <li>• Next...</li> <li>• I'd like to now discuss...</li> <li>• Let's now consider...</li> <li>• Let me tell you about</li> </ul>                       |
| Conclude your presentation                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• In conclusion, I'd like to say...</li> <li>• To summarise...</li> </ul>                                                                                                            |
| Thank the audience                                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Thank you for listening.</li> <li>• Thank you for your attention.</li> </ul>                                                                                                       |



### Let us write

Creative slogans are used to spread a message to capture the reader's attention. Some examples are given below:

- Education is the Key, Unlock Your Destiny!
- Protect the Environment Today for a Better Tomorrow
- Learn, Grow, Succeed
- Go Green by Keeping the Planet Clean

Your school wishes to express gratitude to the farmers who play an important role in providing us the food on our plates. Draft a creative slogan to be put up on the school notice board.



**Remember to**

- focus on the main idea to be expressed
- use simple language
- be concise—express yourself in a few words

You may write the slogan on a chart paper and decorate it.

**Let us explore**

I Millets are a varied group of small-seeded grasses. They have more fibre and minerals than other cereals. Millets have been a part of the Indian cuisine for years. They have been rediscovered worldwide as superfoods.

1. Read the information on Pearl Millet given below.

## Pearl Millet (Pennisetum glaucum (L.) R. Br.)

**Common name:**  
Bajra

**Vernacular names:**

Spiked millet or Pearl millet (English),  
Bajra (Bengali, Hindi, Oriya, Punjabi, Urdu),  
Bajree (Rajasthani, Gujarati, Marathi),  
Sajje (Kannada), Kambu (Tamil),  
Sajja (Telugu)

**Cultivation areas:**

Rajasthan,  
Maharashtra,  
Gujarat,  
Uttar Pradesh and  
Haryana

### Nutritional Profile:

Highest niacin content amongst all cereals; rich in protein and dietary fiber.

| NUTRIENTS        | VALUE PER 100 GRAMS |
|------------------|---------------------|
| Energy (Kcal)    | 347                 |
| Protein (g)      | 10.9                |
| Fat (g)          | 5.43                |
| Carbohydrate (g) | 61.8                |
| Ca (mg)          | 27.4                |
| Fe (mg)          | 6.4                 |
| Folic Acid (µg)  | 36.1                |

It is the sixth major cereal in terms of area and production and has the highest drought tolerance potential of all millets. Pearl millet is the most widely cultivated cereal in India after rice and wheat.

### Health benefits:

- Reduces cholesterol
- Promotes bone health
- Beneficial in treating stomach ulcers
- Promotes heart health
- Aids in weight loss

**Uses:** Khichdi, Roti, Upma, Idli, Khakhra, Parathas

Use the link given below to know more about other kinds of millets.

<https://eatrightindia.gov.in/millets2023/assets/documents/Millets%20-%20Nutritious%20Cereal%20of%20India.pdf>

2. Work in groups of four and do the following activities.

- Find out if millets are a part of your cuisine.
- Find recipes with millets and compile them into a booklet.
- Create a recipe of your choice.

II Songs related to harvest season form a part of our culture and heritage.

Talk to the elders in your house and learn a song sung on a harvest festival. Share it with your classmates and teacher. Then, compile all the songs to create a songbook with the help of teacher.

## WAITING FOR THE RAIN

**Let us do these activities before we read.**

- I Have you ever waited for the rains? Why?
- II How do you feel when it rains after a long time?
- III Why do you think the farmers wait for the rains?
- IV Discuss in groups what happens when you wait for something or someone for a long period of time.
  - 1. How do you spend the waiting period ?
  - 2. What do you think about ?
  - 3. How do you feel ?

Share your answers with your classmates and teacher.





## Let us read



I

“I hope it rains at least today,” Velu thought, as he opened his eyes.

Velu was a farmer. The sun was beginning to rise, glowing **crimson** like fire. Velu scanned the sky. There was not a cloud.

“It doesn’t look encouraging,” he muttered to himself and got up.

Rain or no rain, a farmer wakes up early. Velu worked hard. His piece of land never failed him. Season after season he cultivated it, harvesting jowar one season and dhal the next. Throughout the year he worked, never thinking of rest or taking a holiday. For nearly six years it had been so, ever since he had got his own piece of land.

But this year turned out to be different. At the end of

**crimson:** deep red colour

**untended:** not looked for

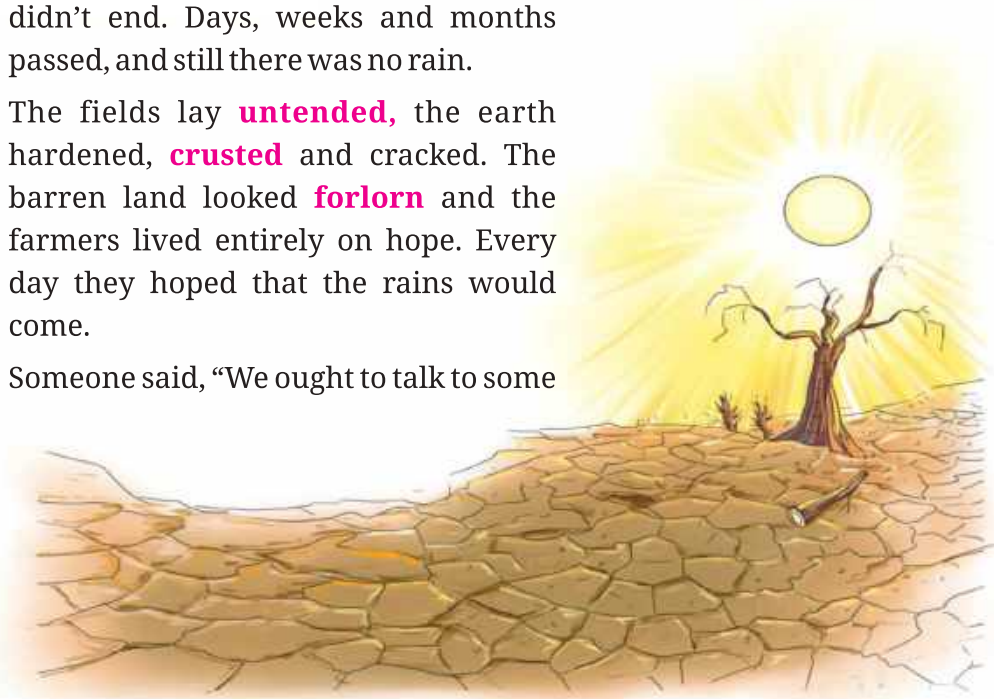
**crusted:** formed a hard outer layer

**forlorn:** sad and neglected

summer, the rains didn’t come. Velu and his neighbours waited, but their waiting didn’t end. Days, weeks and months passed, and still there was no rain.

The fields lay **untended**, the earth hardened, **crusted** and cracked. The barren land looked **forlorn** and the farmers lived entirely on hope. Every day they hoped that the rains would come.

Someone said, “We ought to talk to some



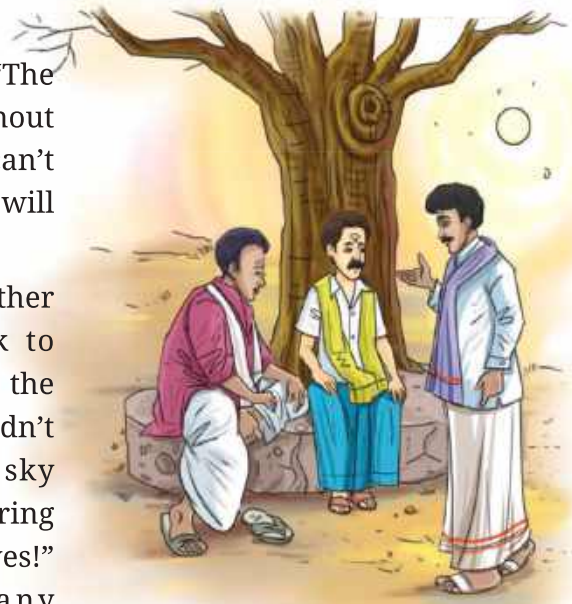
**consultations:**  
discussions

**at a loss:**  
puzzled

astrologers. They can tell us what will please the heavens and the heavens will send down rain.”

Velu didn't agree. He said, “The rains came all these years without any such **consultations**; I can't see how talking to astrologers will bring rain.”

He decided to go to the weather office in the city and talk to someone. But the people at the weather office said they couldn't really tell him when the sky would gather clouds and bring rain. “We are **at a loss** ourselves!” they exclaimed. “So many



favourable conditions but still no rain. Very odd!”

Velu, too, was at a loss. He walked back to the village, tired, and **dejected**. He was thirsty and the dust made him cough and sneeze. He decided to rest for a while.

**dejected:**  
sad and  
disappointed

He saw a large tree. Its shade was cool and inviting. As he sat down, he noticed that an old woman was also sitting there, sheltering from the sun.



## Let us discuss

I Complete the table given below. One example has been done for you.

| What was Said                                                       | Who Said | What was Said | Who Said                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|---------------|--------------------------|
| 1. It doesn't look encouraging.                                     | Velu     | to himself    | He looked up at the sky. |
| 2. The rains came all these years without any such consultations... | Velu     |               |                          |
| 3. So many favourable conditions but still no rain.                 |          |               |                          |

II Do you think the old woman would help Velu? If yes, why? If no, why not?

III Will Velu's wait continue or will it rain?

## II

Her skin was wrinkled, but her eyes sparkled when she smiled. She looked at Velu and her smile grew wider, her wrinkles deeper.

"What are you smiling at, Amma?" Velu asked.

"Without the rains, there's nothing to smile about."

"Yes, yes, you're right," the old woman said, the smile leaving her lips.

"I wonder what I have done to deserve this," Velu began. "I have worked hard and honestly. Yet I am being punished. Without the rains I can't till the land. If I don't till the land no crop will grow."



What will happen to me ? How shall I feed my family?" he asked, somewhat **bitterly**. He wasn't speaking to anyone in particular, but the old lady thought that he was opening his heart to her.

"Perhaps you have worked too hard," she said.

"What do you mean? Can anyone work too hard? I have only done what any hard-working farmer would do.

I shall work and never rest until I am too old.

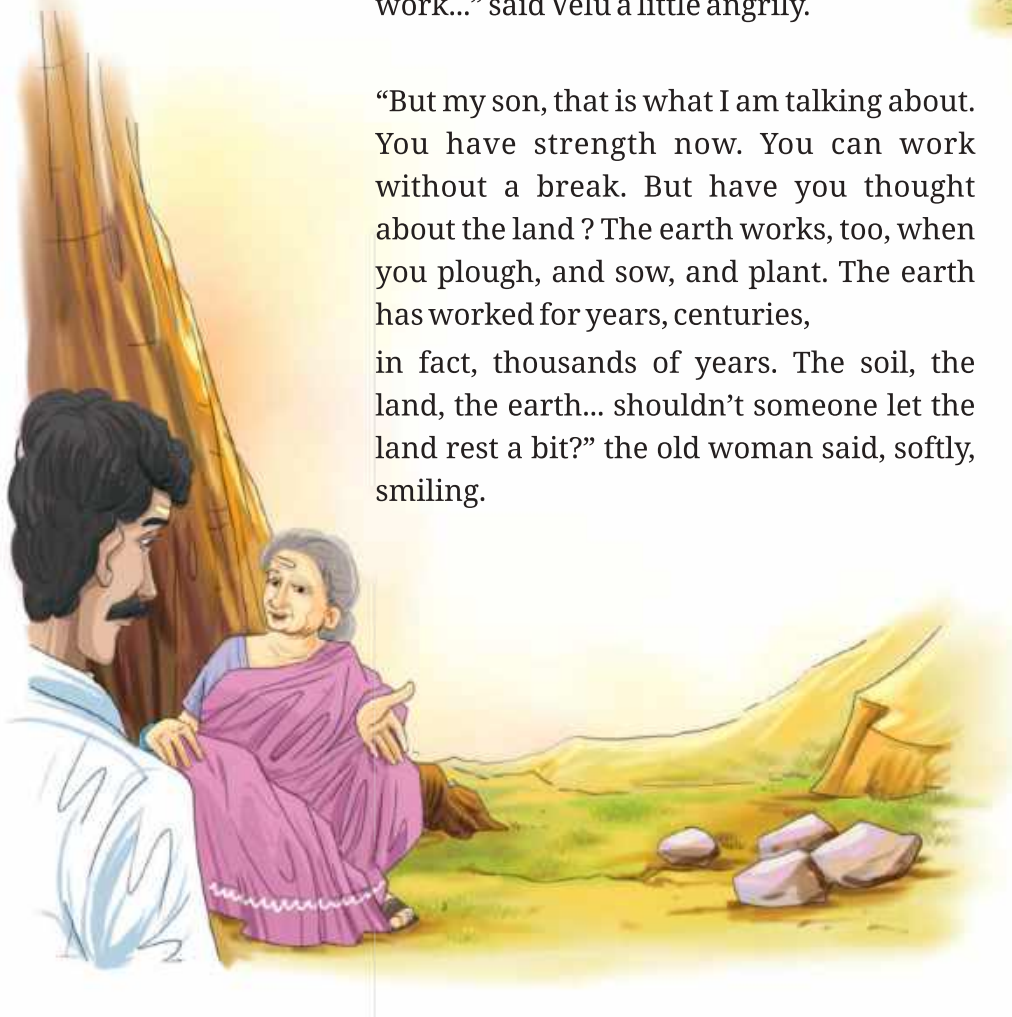
This is the first season in five,

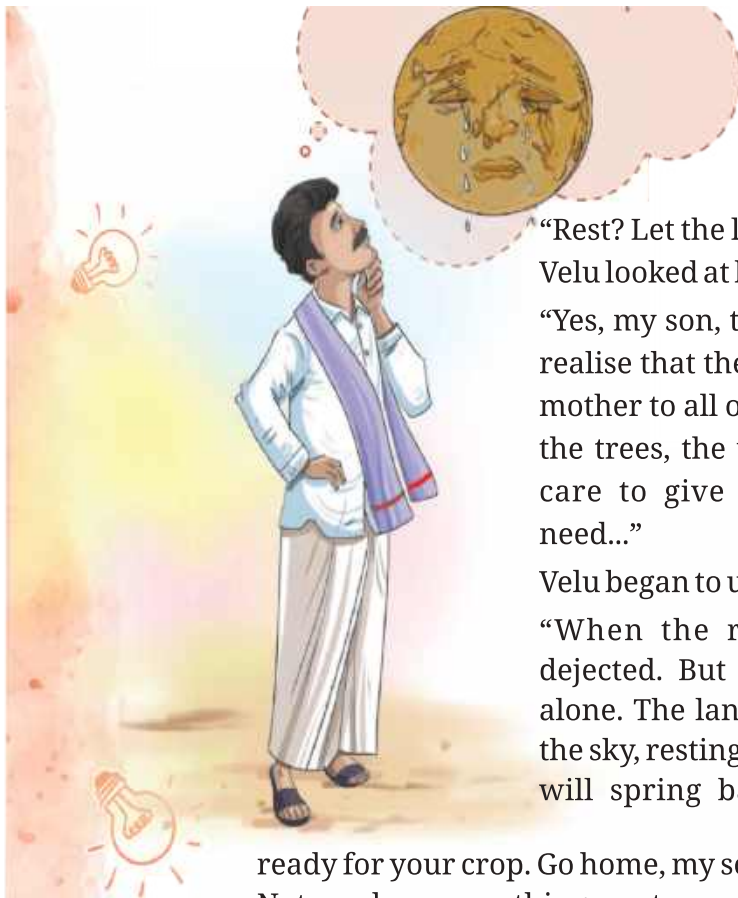
no, six years that I have not sown, nor ploughed. Oh, it is hard not to be able to

work..." said Velu a little angrily.

"But my son, that is what I am talking about. You have strength now. You can work without a break. But have you thought about the land ? The earth works, too, when you plough, and sow, and plant. The earth has worked for years, centuries, in fact, thousands of years. The soil, the land, the earth... shouldn't someone let the land rest a bit?" the old woman said, softly, smiling.

**bitterly:**  
hurtfully





“Rest? Let the land rest? I don’t understand,” Velu looked at her, a little puzzled.

“Yes, my son, that is the difficulty. You don’t realise that the earth is old... But Nature is a mother to all of us. To you and to me. And to the trees, the water and the soil. She takes care to give her children the rest they need...”

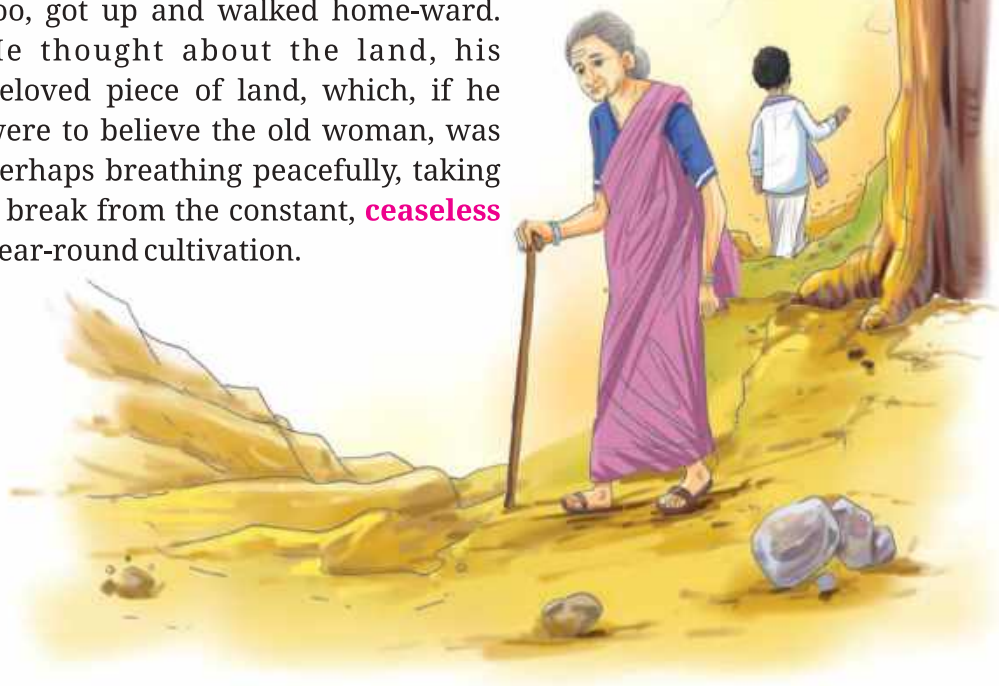
Velu began to understand.

“When the rains don’t come, you are dejected. But in that way the land is left alone. The land lies undisturbed, staring at the sky, resting... And when the rains come, it will spring back into activity, fresh and

ready for your crop. Go home, my son, Nature knows a thing or two... go home,” she said, and got up.

She walked away. After a while Velu, too, got up and walked home-ward. He thought about the land, his beloved piece of land, which, if he were to believe the old woman, was perhaps breathing peacefully, taking a break from the constant, **ceaseless** year-round cultivation.

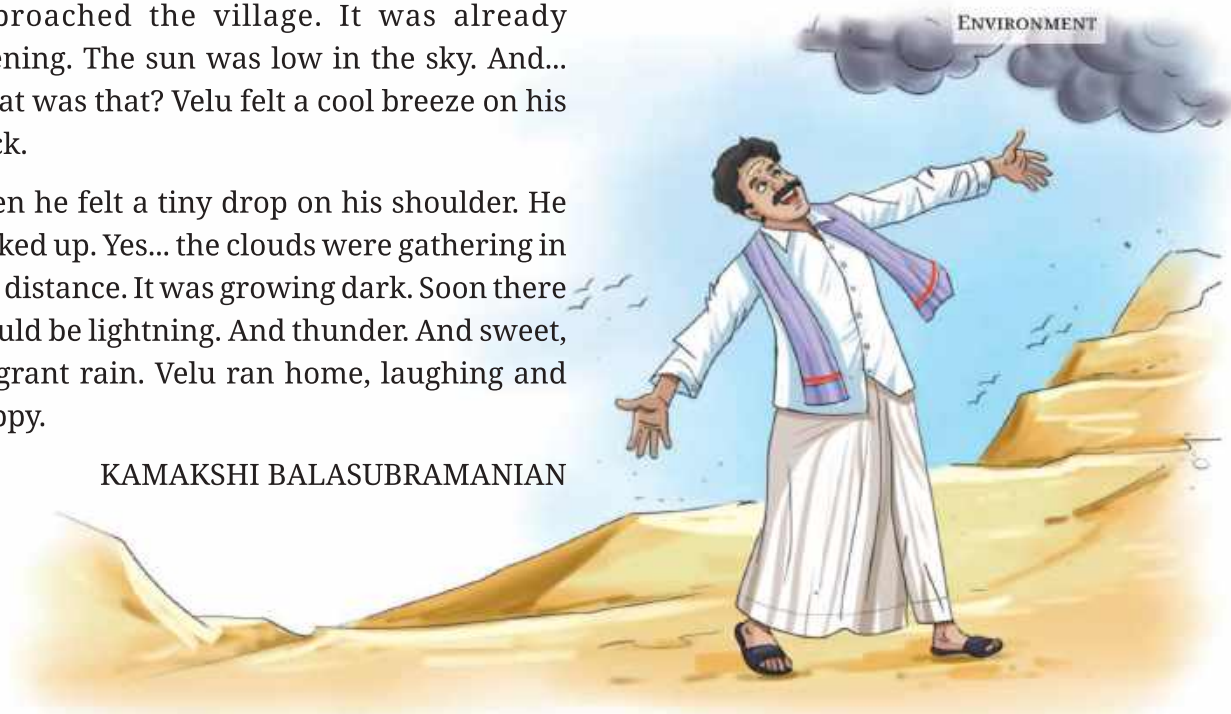
**ceaseless:**  
continuous



“Perhaps she is right,” he thought, as he approached the village. It was already evening. The sun was low in the sky. And... what was that? Velu felt a cool breeze on his back.

Then he felt a tiny drop on his shoulder. He looked up. Yes... the clouds were gathering in the distance. It was growing dark. Soon there would be lightning. And thunder. And sweet, fragrant rain. Velu ran home, laughing and happy.

KAMAKSHI BALASUBRAMANIAN



### Let us discuss

- I Complete the following statements given below with suitable reasons.
1. Velu asked the old woman to stop smiling because \_\_\_\_\_.
2. Velu said that it was hard not being able to work since \_\_\_\_\_.
3. Velu was confused when the old lady said that the land needed rest because \_\_\_\_\_.
4. The old lady said that it was good for the land when it didn't rain as \_\_\_\_\_.
5. Velu ran home laughing and happy because \_\_\_\_\_.



### Let us think and reflect

- I Read the given extracts and answer the questions that follow.
1. “...I can't see how talking to astrologers will bring rain.”  
*He decided to go to the weather office in the city and talk to someone. But the people at the weather office said they couldn't really tell him when the sky would gather clouds and bring rain. “We are at a loss ourselves!” they exclaimed. “So many favourable conditions but still no rain. Very odd!”*



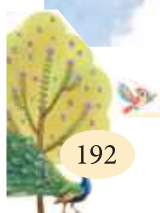


- (i) What does the first line of the extract tell us about Velu's beliefs?
- (ii) Complete the following sentence with a suitable reason.  
Velu is determined to seek information about the rain because \_\_\_\_\_. (he was at a loss of words/he wants to find a practical solution to the drought affecting his farm)
- (iii) Velu went to weather office. What was his expectation and what was the actual outcome?

| Expectation (What I think will happen) | Outcome (What actually happened) |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
|                                        |                                  |



- (iv) Complete the following sentence with a suitable option. The absence of rain despite favourable conditions, shows \_\_\_\_\_.  
 A. lack of astrological knowledge  
 B. ineffectiveness of farmers like Velu  
 C. delay in understanding the weather  
 D. unpredictability of nature
2. *"The soil, the land, the earth... shouldn't someone let the land rest a bit?" the old woman said, softly, smiling.*  
*"Rest? Let the land rest? I don't understand," Velu looked at her, a little puzzled.*  
*"Yes, my son, that is the difficulty. You don't realise that the earth is old..."*
  - (i) The old woman's advice was accompanied with a soft tone and a smile. What does that tell us about her?
  - (ii) Fill in the blank with the correct option from those given below.  
The old woman's advice \_\_\_\_\_ Velu, at that moment.  
 A. failed to impress      B. confused  
 C. scared                      D. made sense to
  - (iii) State one thing about the old woman when she referred to Velu as 'my son', while offering advice.
  - (iv) Complete the following sentence with a suitable explanation.  
The 'difficulty' that the old woman mentions is due to the fact that \_\_\_\_\_.



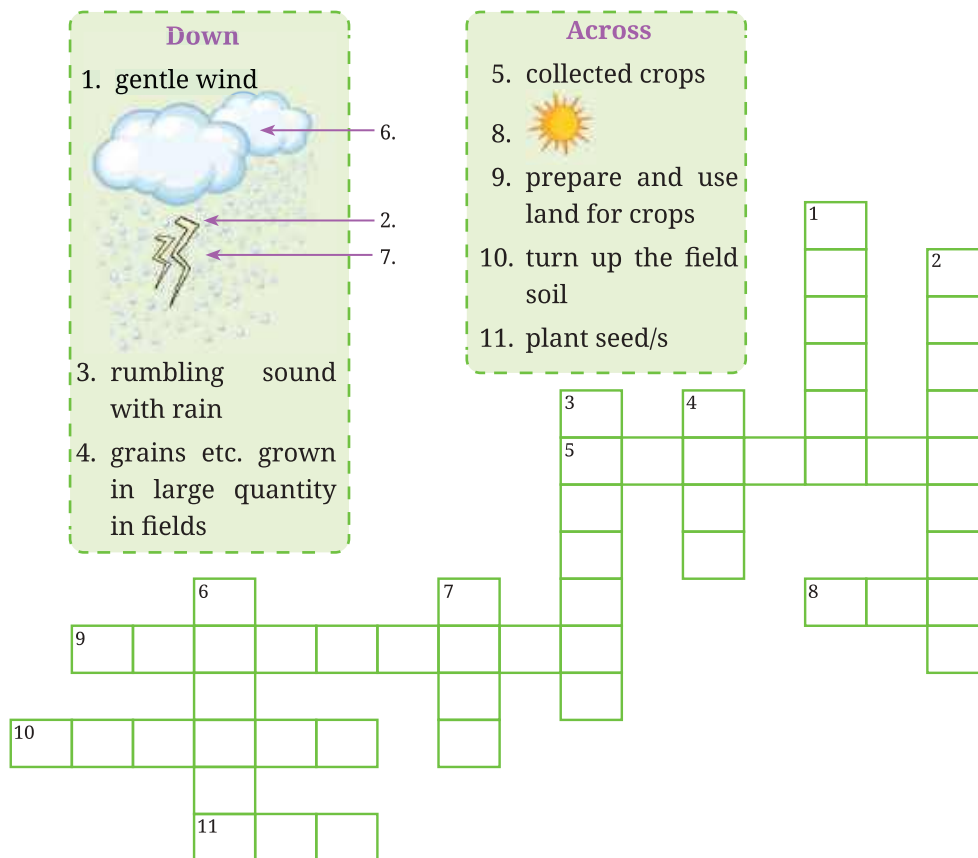
## II. Answer the following questions.

1. How does the old woman convey Nature's wisdom to Velu?
2. The writer says, 'The fields lay untended...' Why couldn't the farmers tend to their fields in the absence of rain?
3. Support the old woman's perspective that the land needs rest just like people do.
4. What can be inferred about Velu's character based on his reaction to the drought?
5. What does the story suggest about the life of farmers and their relationship with nature?
6. How might the rest and care of land contribute to a balanced and sustainable ecosystem?



## Let us learn

- I. Solve a crossword using picture and word clues. All clues are related to the words from the text that are connected to weather or agriculture.



- II. The text uses words like 'piece,' 'weather,' 'son,' and 'rain'. These words are the same as other words that are spelt differently—peace, whether, sun, and reign.

Words that are pronounced the same as other words but differ in meaning or in spelling are called **homophones**.

Now, complete the paragraph by filling in the correct option of homophones given in the brackets.



The farmer looked at the sky and wondered 1. \_\_\_\_\_ (weather/whether) the clouds would finally bring rain. He sat down on the ground, breaking a small 2. \_\_\_\_\_ (piece/peace) of roti for his meal. The 3. \_\_\_\_\_ (plain/plane) fields stretched endlessly before him, completely dry. He thought about how he could 4. \_\_\_\_\_ (sell/cell) his last sack of grain to buy some essentials for his family. Without the rains, it didn't 5. \_\_\_\_\_ (seam/seem) possible to grow another crop this season. Despite his worries, he smiled, knowing that every farmer hopes for the next 6. \_\_\_\_\_ (rain/reign) by nature to bring life back to the land.

- III Choose the correct meanings from the given options for the underlined words or phrases in the following sentences.

- Being annoyed, she muttered something which nobody heard.  
(i) spoke in a low voice (ii) spoke slowly (iii) spoke angrily
- At the new work place, Riya felt forlorn for a week.  
(i) upset and irritated (ii) angry and bitter (iii) sad and neglected
- When all his friends had gone, he was at a loss because he did not know what to do.  
(i) confused (ii) shocked (iii) lonely
- When the little child saw her father, her eyes sparkled.  
(i) glowed dimly (ii) showed joy (iii) opened wide

- IV. Match each word (adjective) in Column 1 with a word (noun) that collocates in Column 2. Write the adjective-noun collocation in Column 3. One example has been done for you.

| Column 1      | Column 2        | Column 3           |
|---------------|-----------------|--------------------|
| 1. favourable | (i) country     | favourable weather |
| 2. wrinkled   | (ii) activity   |                    |
| 3. dejected   | (iii) weather   |                    |
| 4. fragrant   | (iv) skin       |                    |
| 5. ceaseless  | (v) garden      |                    |
| 6. beloved    | (vi) expression |                    |

- V. Underline the verbs and identify the forms of tenses for the following sentences from the text.

- Oh, it is hard not to be able to work...
- ...I am too old.
- What are you smiling at, Amma?
- But my son, that is what I am talking about.
- The earth has worked for years, centuries...
- I have worked hard and honestly.

The forms of tenses in the given statements are Simple Present Tense (1 and 2), Present Progressive Tense (3 and 4) Present Perfect Tense (5 and 6).

Now, fill in the blanks with the correct form of Simple Present, Present Progressive or Present Perfect tenses of the verbs given in brackets. Ravi (i) \_\_\_\_\_ (be) a farmer who (ii) \_\_\_\_\_ (practise) crop rotation on his land. Each season, he (iii) \_\_\_\_\_ (plant) different crops to maintain the soil's health. This year, he (iv) \_\_\_\_\_ (grow) legumes, which help restore the nutrients in the soil. Over the years, Ravi (v) \_\_\_\_\_ (learn) that planting the same crop repeatedly (vi) \_\_\_\_\_ (deplete) the soil, making it less fertile. By rotating crops, he (vii) \_\_\_\_\_ (keep) the land productive and fertile. He (viii) \_\_\_\_\_ (see) a noticeable improvement in his yields since adopting this method. Now, Ravi (ix) \_\_\_\_\_ (share) his knowledge with other farmers, explaining how crop rotation(x) \_\_\_\_\_ (benefit) both the soil and their harvests.

VI. Study the highlighted words in the following sentences from the text.

- **The** rains came **all** these years without **any** such consultations.
- So **many** favourable conditions, but still no rain.
- **Every** day they hoped that • rains would come.
- But **this** year turned out to be different.
- This is **the** first season in **five**, no, **six** years that I have not sown, nor ploughed.
- We ought to talk to **some** astrologers.
- I have only done what **any** hard-working farmer would do.
- Velu looked at her, **a little** puzzled.
- She takes care to give **her** children **the** rest they need...
- Velu felt **a** cool breeze on **his** back.

The highlighted words or phrases that come before a noun but do not describe them are called **determiners**.

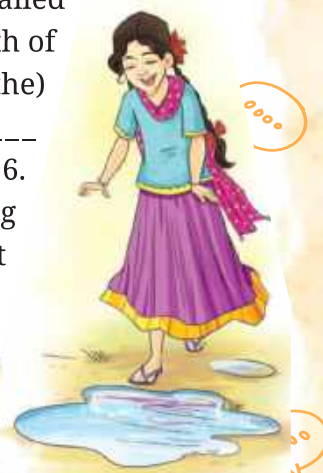
Let us learn the use of some common determiners.

- **Articles:** a, an, the  
These are used to introduce nouns.
- **Demonstrative Determiners:** this, that, these, those  
These are used to point out specific items.
- **Possessive Determiners:** my, our, your, his, her, its, their, one's  
These indicate ownership or relationship.
- **Definite Numeral Determiners:** one, two, three, etc.  
These specify exact quantities.
- **Indefinite Numeral Determiners:** some, any, no, all, much, many, few, less, several, little and few
  - 'Some' is used in affirmative sentences, while 'any' and 'no' are used in negative and interrogative sentences.
  - 'All' refers to the entirety of a group.
  - 'Much' and 'many' denote large quantities of uncountable and countable nouns, respectively.
  - 'Few' indicates a small number, 'less' refers to a smaller quantity, and 'several' means more than two but not many.
  - 'Little' means not much, 'few' means not many. Use 'a little' and 'a few' to convey a positive sense.

- Distributive Determiners: each, every, either, neither
  - 'Each' refers to individual items or people, 'every' refers to all items or people collectively.
  - 'Either' means one of two options and 'neither' means not one of the two options.

Now, fill in the blanks by choosing the correct determiner from those given in the brackets.

It was 1. \_\_\_\_\_ (a/an) rainy afternoon, and 2. \_\_\_\_\_ Mala noticed a large puddle quickly forming in front of 3. \_\_\_\_\_ (her/their) house. Excited, she called for her brother to join her, knowing that both of them always loved playing in 4. \_\_\_\_\_ (a/the) rain. While jumping from 5. \_\_\_\_\_ (some/one) puddle to another, Mala spotted 6. \_\_\_\_\_ (few/a few) snails slowly creeping along the wet sidewalk and pointed them out to her brother. With 7. \_\_\_\_\_ (each/every) jump, the sound of both 8. \_\_\_\_\_ (her/their) squeals and laughter was heard through the soft patter of raindrops. Though they were fully drenched 9. \_\_\_\_\_ (either/neither) siblings minded it. It had been a perfect rainy day.



### Let us listen

- I. Listen to the weather forecast. As you listen, fill in the blanks with the exact word you listen to. (Transcript for teacher on page 204)
1. Delhi will mostly have a \_\_\_\_\_ sky with light rain.
  2. Moderate rain is likely to happen in \_\_\_\_\_.
  3. Kolkata is likely to have a maximum temperature of around \_\_\_\_\_ °C.
  4. There is a chance of a \_\_\_\_\_ in Chennai.
  5. Bengaluru will have a \_\_\_\_\_ temperature of 29 °C.
  6. Taking an \_\_\_\_\_ is advisable because of the weather conditions.





## Let us speak

- I. Here is a tongue twister about 'weather'. Practice saying it as fast as you can.



Whether the weather be fine, or whether the weather be not, whether the weather be cold, or whether the weather be hot, we'll weather the weather, whatever the weather, whether we like it or not.

- II. Rain has arrived after a long dry spell on the Earth. Imagine the Rain and the Earth have a conversation. Work in pairs and present the role-play.

You may use the hints in the table given below.

You may start the conversation in the following way.

Rain: Greetings, Earth! It's been a while since we've met. How have you been?

Earth: Hello Rain! I am so glad to see you.

To continue the conversation, use the hints given below.



### Rain

Ask about how the Earth has been.

Speak about your long journey from the Earth to the sky and back again to the Earth.

Ask about how the Earth can use the gift you brought—rain water.

Elaborate how much you enjoy being on the Earth.

Thank the Earth for the invite. Promise to return on time the next year.

### Earth

Respond and express relief at the arrival of Rain.

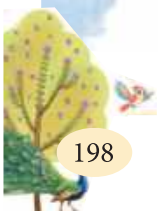
Enquire why it took so long for Rain to arrive.

Express gratitude for the gift of water.

Speak about how important Rain is to you—for agriculture, for plants and animals to survive.

Enquire how Rain feels about being on Earth.

Invite Rain to join the celebration of the rivers, forests, and people of Earth.





## Let us write

- I. You have observed the difficulties faced by the people in your neighbourhood due to scarcity of water especially during the summer months. Write a letter to the Councillor of your Municipal ward, requesting her/him to set up a rain water harvesting unit. Provide suggestions to address the issue.

### Remember to

- use formal language
- keep sentences short and to the point
- state the purpose clearly and concisely
- give relevant details

### Format and Layout:

Sender's address

Date

To

The Municipal Councillor (*Receiver's designation and address*)

Subject: Request to Install a Rainwater Harvesting Unit in Ward

No. 44

Dear Madam,

Paragraph 1: Drawing attention to the problem

Paragraph 2: Causes and Consequences

Paragraph 3: Request and Suggestions

Paragraph 4: Conclusion

} Body of the letter

Yours sincerely,

Signature of the sender

(*Sender's full name in brackets*)



## Let us explore

- I. Rest is very important for us to function in a proper manner. Even the Earth needs rest. This is known as **fallowing**.

Read the facts given below related to fallowing:

- A fallow year refers to leaving the land without sowing for one, or several vegetative cycles.





- This is done to allow the land to recover its nutrients and retain moisture. It also helps to avoid spreading of diseases and controlling pests.
- The sustainable land management method has been applied for centuries, wherein a field is divided into two halves—one is planted with crops while the other remains unplanted. Then, the process is reversed in the following year.

II. Find out from your Vocational Education teacher about Agriculture as a vocation and other related vocations, such as horticulture, etc.

III. India's rich tradition of meteorological knowledge includes indigenous forecasting systems, grounded in ancient wisdom. These provide sophisticated methods for predicting climate, calculating rainfall, and issuing early warnings.

References to rain and weather are found in numerous ancient texts, including the *Rigveda*, *Shrimad Bhagavad*, *Parashara Samhita*, *Panini's Ashtadhyayi*, and *Meghmala*. These texts offer insights into rainfall patterns and seasonal changes.



IV. Meteorological Services for Agriculture in India

The primary objective of the Agricultural Meteorology Division, India Meteorological Department (IMD) is to minimise the impact of adverse weather on crops and to leverage crop-weather relationships to boost agricultural production.

In addition to forecasts and advisories, several other weather related services are also provided.

For detailed information, please visit: <https://mausam.imd.gov.in/responsive/servicesMetEnvironment.php>

